

Question:
At birth, the least developed part of the brain is the

Answer Choices:

- A. visual system
- B. thalamus
- C. frontal lobe
- D. brain stem
- E. parietal lobe
- F. cerebellum
- G. cortex
- H. basal ganglia
- I. hypothalamus
- J. limbic system

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>
Birth reflects an organized , temporal cascade of development : the brain progresses from basic structures (primitive divisions) to regions with mature connectivity and complex functions (neomorphic divisions).

- Primitive divisions (e.g ., brain stem , cerebellum) form very early during embryogenesis . Their basic organization (stem cells , white matter tracts , pontine nuclei) is established by mid - gestation , so by birth these are largely complete .
- Neomorphic divisions (e.g ., cerebral cortex , limbic system , association areas) develop later . The neocortex and hippocampus enlarge postnatally and show extensive interneuron migration and synaptogenesis through the perinatal period ; the anterior thalamus matures further during early infancy . Thus , at birth these areas are still developing .

Therefore , at birth the least developed , least mature part of the brain is the cortical divisions (cerebral cortex , hippocampus , thalamus , etc .).

Correct answer : G . cortex

</think>
<answer>
G . cortex
</answer>

